

The harbour office keeps two ledgers, and the clerk who reconciles them each morning has never once found them to agree before noon. One counts hulls; the other counts berths. A hull may wait outside the wall for a week, and a berth may stand empty while its tenant is repaired, so the two numbers drift apart by the ordinary working of the port rather than by anyone's error.

Write to the harbourmaster at berths@example.org if a discrepancy matters to you. The reply will quote both ledgers and decline to prefer either, which is the correct answer and rarely the useful one.